The Rite of the Torma

Balividhi · Toh 1285 · Derge Tengyur

གཏོར་མའི་ཆོ་ག

The Rite of the Torma, in Tibetan Tormé Choga and in Sanskrit Balividhi, is a brief tantric ritual manual catalogued as Toh 1285 in the Tengyur, among the commentaries on the tantras. Written in homage to Vajraḍāka and belonging to the Cakrasaṃvara cycle centered on Heruka, it describes how a practitioner, visualizing himself as Heruka, generates all beings of the three realms and the eight charnel grounds as a maṇḍala of deities, prepares and blesses the torma offering as nectar in a skull cup, and invites the wisdom deities and the ḍākinīs of the five families to partake of it. The rite includes offering mantras, a praise of the five buddha families in the form of ḍākinīs, a verse on the illusory nature of phenomena, an offering to the local guardian spirits, aspiration prayers for the welfare of all beings, and the closing request for the deities to depart.

In the language of India: bilaṃbidhiḥ. In the language of Tibet: The Rite of the Torma.

Homage to glorious Vajraḍāka.

Having bowed to glorious Vajraḍāka
and paid homage with faith,
in order to protect all sentient beings
I shall write down the rite of the torma.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

In a single instant one meditates on emptiness. Then one says hūṃ, and from hūṃ, in a single instant, within the vajra ground, fence and net, one generates all the sentient beings of the three realms, together with the eight charnel grounds, as the maṇḍala of the deities. One imagines oneself, too, in the form of Heruka in front of it, and one should protect oneself by recollecting the six syllables, the three syllables, and the deities of the crown.

Then below, from yaṃ and raṃ, one generates wind and fire, and from a one generates a skull cup. Within it one imagines the five meats together with the nectars. In the space above it, from hūṃ, one generates a vajra upon a moon. The wind kindles the fire, the fire boils the nectar, and by its light the moon and the vajra also dissolve and become the nectar of the gods. Above it one imagines oṃ. With its light rays one draws in the nectar of wisdom and

dissolves it into it, and by reciting the mantra of the three syllables three times, one blesses it.

Then, with the light rays of the seed syllable at one's heart, one invites the wisdom deities, saying aṃ śrīherukamahāvajra āgaccha a a a ghata a praveśaya praveśaya bandhaya bandhaya toṣaya toṣaya sarvva vajraḍākinīhṛdaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ, and dissolves them into the commitment maṇḍala. Again one makes offerings with offerings arisen from the mind.

Then one imagines on the tongues of the deities and of the lords of the eight charnel grounds a vajra the size of a barley grain arising from hūṃ, and meditates on hūṃ at its tip. With its light rays one draws up the nectar, and one imagines that by partaking of it they attain nondual wisdom. The mantras are: oṃ śrīherukavajra pratīccha maṃ baliṃ hūṃ phaṭ. oṃ buddhaḍākinī pratīccha maṃ bilaṃ oṃ phaṭ. oṃ vajraḍākinī pratīccha maṃ laliṃ hūṃ phaṭ. oṃ ratnaḍākinī pratīccha maṃ baliṃ trāṃ phaṭ. oṃ viśvaḍākinī pratīccha maṃ baliṃ a phaṭ. oṃ sarvaḍākinī pratīccha maṃ baliṃ hūṃ phaṭ. oṃ sarvvayoginī pratīccha maṃ baliṃ hūṃ ha ha he hoḥ.

Then the praise of the five realities:

Akṣobhya, the great wisdom,
the vajra sphere, the great space,
supreme of the three vajras, the three maṇḍalas:
homage to Vajraḍākinī.
Vairocana, utterly pure,
vajra peace, the great joy,
by nature the supreme clear light:
homage to Buddhaḍākinī.
King of jewels, most profound,
vajra sky without stain,
pure of both things, untainted:
homage to Ratnaḍākinī.
Vajra deathless, great passion,
nonconceptual sky, vajra holder,
who has reached the far shore of passion:
homage to Padmaḍākinī.
Vajra pure, who does not devour beings,
who fully understands every intention,

arisen from the very nature of the buddhas:
homage to Viśvaḍākinī.

Phenomena are like reflections,
pure and clear, without turbidity,
ungraspable and inexpressible,
arising entirely from causes and karma,
not abiding by any essential nature.
Having understood this Dharma in that way,
act without equal for the benefit of sentient beings,
and so be born as heirs of the buddhas.

oṃ āḥ hūṃ, of the place called so and so and the rest, kṣatrapāla idaṃ baliṃ gṛhṇa mamas parivārāna sarvasatvañja pāpaṃ byati viśnaṃ śāntiṃ kuru dhana dhana ātu ādi puṣṭiṃ kuru sarva prayaccha rakṣa kuru svāhā.

May all sentient beings be free of sickness,
may all sentient beings be happy,
and may they go upon that very path
by which they meet with buddhahood.
May those not yet freed be freed,
may those not yet across be ferried over,
and may the treatises of yoga that endure
endure right now.

After that, with the three syllables, one entrusts them with the activities of pacifying and the rest. Then one says oṃ āḥ hūṃ vajra muḥ, snaps the fingers three times, and requests them to depart.

It is complete.

Translator's Notes

• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as an evident slip for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "bless." In "the deities and the lords of the eight charnel grounds," □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□. "The praise of the five realities" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, a praise of the five buddha families as ḍākinīs; the fifth family name is taken from the "variegated" (sna tshogs), Viśva, and the ḍākinī names elsewhere from the mantras. The line "who does not devour beings" (gdon mi za) is uncertain; it may rather mean "unfailing."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.